

100 Days of Linux - Day 008

Title: Moving and Renaming Files with mv

Today's Goal

Learn how to move files between directories and rename files using the **mv** command.

Why This Matters

Developers regularly organize project files, rename scripts, and move data into different folders. The mv command is used constantly.

Command of the Day: mv

Syntax: mv SOURCE DESTINATION

Explanation: Moves or renames files and directories.

Examples:

```
mv notes.txt notes_old.txt
mv report.csv backup/
```

Beginner Lesson

Unlike **cp**, the **mv** command does not create a copy. It moves the original file or changes its name. After using mv, the original location no longer contains that file.

Practice Questions

1. Create a file named notes.txt and rename it to notes_day8.txt.
2. Create a directory named backup and move notes_day8.txt into it.
3. List the contents of the backup directory to verify the move.
4. Create a directory named projects and rename it to linux_projects.
5. Display your current working directory.

Hints

Use touch to create files, mkdir to create directories, mv to move or rename, and ls to verify.

Mini Challenge

Create a folder named practice. Inside it create app.py, data.csv, and notes.txt. Rename notes.txt to readme.txt, then move all three files into a new folder named archive.

Common Mistakes

Expecting mv to keep a copy behind. It moves the original unless you're copying with cp.

Did You Know?

Renaming a file in Linux is done with the same mv command used for moving files.

Pro Tip

Run ls before and after mv to confirm the file is where you expect.

Answer Key (Instructor Only)

Q1: touch notes.txt && mv notes.txt notes_day8.txt

Q2: mkdir backup && mv notes_day8.txt backup/

Q3: ls backup

Q4: mkdir projects && mv projects linux_projects

Q5: pwd

Homework

Practice renaming five files and moving them into different directories.

Next Day Preview

Tomorrow you'll learn the history command and how to reuse previously executed commands efficiently.